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Minutes of the 2nd CRF Operations Committee Meeting

The 2nd meeting of the CRF Operations Committee was held in the CRF Office, Block V, at 3:00 PM on the 17th of November 2025.

It was attended by the following members:

Prof. Manidipa Banerjee (Chairperson, Head CRF)

Prof. Bhanu Nandan (Associate Head CRF)

Prof. S Nagendran, Department of Chemistry

Prof. Jayant Jain, Department of Material Science and Engineering

Prof Pankaj Srivastava, Department of Physics

Prof Amit Gupta, Department of Mechanical Engineering

Prof Manjesh Kumar, Department of Chemical Engineering

Prof Jatin Panwar from the Department of Biochemical Engineering and Biotechnology could not attend because of prior commitments.

The following agenda items were discussed:

Item 1. Requests for sharing of equipment with CRF: All members agreed on the following modes for operation of CRF equipment.

1) Shared mode: Equipment purchased from external grants by faculty/academic units to be shared with CRF for 1-2 days. CRF facilitates the booking of the equipment by internal/external users, and 80% of the revenues are available to the faculty/academic unit for their use. CRF does not take responsibility for AMC/consumable/manpower, and equipment is housed in the faculty's laboratory/academic unit space.

2) Co-owned mode: Equipment purchased jointly by PI/Departmental and CRF, where the equipment is available for usage on the CRF website for 3-4 days a week. CRF takes responsibility for consumables, AMC and manpower for CRF-specific usage. The equipment may be placed in a department/PI's laboratory space but CRF has full access.

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3)CRF owned mode: Facilities purchased with funds allocated to CRF from internal/external sources. CRF takes responsibility for consumables, AMC and manpower. Equipment is placed in CRF space and operated by CRF staff.

The Operational Committee suggested dynamic, usage-dependent switching between modes 1 and 2 based on evaluation of usage statistics. If CRF receives a request from faculty/academic units for equipment sharing, such requests may be considered by the Operations Committee and approved on the basis of perceived requirement by the researcher community. The usage of shared equipment should be monitored every 6 months. If the equipment is heavily utilized, and if consent is received from the faculty or academic unit, it may be placed in mode 2 (co-owned). Similarly, if an equipment in mode 2 does not show substantial usage, it may be placed in mode 1 (shared).

The Head CRF informed the committee that several requests have been received by CRF for equipment sharing. The committee considered the requests and provided the following decisions:

1)Prof B Kundu (Kusuma School of Biological Sciences): Differential Scanning Calorimeter, Isothermal Titration Calorimeter

The committee noted that the equipment may be required for measuring stability of biomolecules/biologics and small molecule drug binding studies.

Recommended usage in mode 1 (shared mode)

2)Prof Gazala Habib (Dept of Civil Engineering):

Thermal Desorption-Gas Chromatography Mass Spectrometer with sample extraction assembly, 7-wavelength Thermal optical Reflectance analyser for organic and elemental carbon analysis (DRI), Ion chromatograph (ThermoFisher), Inductive coupled plasma-Optical electron spectrometer for trace metal analysis, Microwave digestion system

The committee noted that the GC-MS currently available with CRF is heavily booked and an additional GC-MS with sample preparation setup will be useful.

Recommended usage in mode 1 (shared mode)

3) Prof Sarveshwar Srivastava (Centre for Biomedical Engineering):

Magnetodrome setup, Surface Plasmon Resonance

The committee noted that the equipment will be usable for nano/micro-robotics studies, and drug binding and affinity measurements.

Recommended usage in mode 1 (shared mode)

4) Prof Mayank Kumar (Dept of Mechanical Engineering)

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- Blue initials "H".
- A blue signature "Sarveshwar".
- A blue signature "Mayank Kumar".
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Air pollution monitoring system (Grand Challenges)

The committee noted that while this equipment is essential, similar equipment already exist in SATHI with limited usage. The committee also suggested that CRF should work out a mode for Grand Challenges equipment in line with institute policies.

5) Prof Sandeep Jha (Centre for Biomedical Engineering):

Clean Room (to be constructed)

The committee noted that the facility has not yet been constructed and therefore cannot be taken up in co-owned or shared mode. The committee further stated that if this is to be a CRF owned facility, then broad consensus should be obtained from the institute community for prioritization of equipment; and space issues, particularly availability and accessibility, are to be worked out.

Item 2. Requests for MoU with CRF for facility and knowledge sharing: The Head CRF informed the committee that multiple vendors have approached CRF for sharing of equipment and manpower as per an MoU. There already exists a previous MoU with Horiba Inc, under which CRF provides space for equipment that are partly utilized by internal users, and partly by the vendor. Under the terms of the MoU (renewable every year), the vendor has provided the equipment and manpower for running the facility.

The Head CRF informed the committee that the following proposals have been received:

1) Analytik Jena: The vendor wishes to establish an elemental analysis facility, wherein the following equipment will be transferred to CRF and placed in the Sonipat campus.

ICP-MS

- * ZEE nit 700P Flame + Graphite Furnace AAS with ZEEMAN correction, including auto samplers and Hydride system
- * Specord 210P Variable bandwidth UVVIS spectrophotometer
- * Microwave Digestion System for sample preparation

2) Toshniwal: The vendor wishes to establish an electrochemistry facility under CRF

The committee concurred that both proposed facilities will be usable by the IIT Delhi users, as well as external academic and industrial entities. However, it was suggested that the MoU terms and conditions must be established wherein the vendor should provide the equipment (with new launches also being made available as befitting a centre of excellence) and manpower, while the institute provides suitable space for hosting the equipment. Further, the MoU should be renewable every year to ensure optimal utilization. The Head CRF was asked to share the draft MoU with the committee upon availability.

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Item 3. Staff salary and HRA revision: The Head CRF shared with the committee that the re-mapping of the staff salaries in 2024 has caused some discrepancies in the scales of CRF staff. Further, the issue of HRA increase from 27% to 30% for CRF staff is pending. The committee requested the Head CRF to obtain guidance on this matter from the Central Facilities Committee headed by the DDSP.

Item 4. Leave issues: The committee reiterated that the maximum number of leaves that can be availed yearly by CRF staff is 30. Medical leaves within this period should be accompanied by proper medical certification as per institute rules. Leaves more than 30 in a calendar year, if availed under specific circumstances, must be endorsed by the faculty coordinator and Head/Associate Head CRF, and may result in deduction from salary as per institute rules. The committee further suggested that, if necessary, attendance as per timble/biometric methods should be made available to IRD.

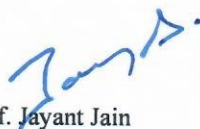
Item 5. Process for holding workshops for CRF internal/external users. The committee was enthusiastic about utilization of CRF equipment/technical knowledge for conducting national workshops. It was suggested that such workshops must be conducted without compromising the availability of sample slots, i.e. ideally over weekends. The committee also suggested that if CRF staff are working over and above their usual working hours to conduct such workshops (not considering institute events), they should be eligible for honorarium, and the norms should be discussed with IRD. The workshop proposal must be approved by the Head/Associate Head CRF and all these modalities considered.

The meeting ended with a vote of thanks to the Chair.

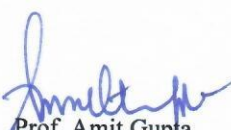

Prof. Manidipa Baerjee
Head CRF


Prof. Bhanu Nandan
Associate Head CRF


Prof. S Nagendran
Member


Prof. Jayant Jain
Member


Prof. Pankaj Srivastava
Member


Prof. Amit Gupta
Member


Prof. Manjesh Kumar
Member

(Not attended the meeting)
Prof. Jatin Panwar